

Awareness increases with company-wide training programmes, expert lectures, and AI meets. Active exploration comes from hackathons and quick POCs (proofs of concepts). Operational impact usually comes through central teams or centres of excellence that identify use cases and implement them. Product-level confidence comes with stronger computing, streamlined pipelines, and model governance. Sentinel level is the long-term vision and represents the highest form of autonomous intelligence.

Inflection

So why is AI suddenly at an inflection point? We have had forms of AI since the early 1900s. The term itself appeared in 1842 and was formally coined in 1956. We have seen expert systems, rule-based systems, games such as Pac-Man and chess, and early healthcare applications. But the real acceleration began around 2011 with recommendation systems

and the rise of machine learning and deep learning.

Today's inflection point is driven by four clear trends:

Data explosion. We collect data, knowingly and unknowingly, from mobile phones, vehicles, applications, and sensors. We have sufficient data to experiment, and algorithms can now generate synthetic data as well.

Cloud computing. Earlier, computing meant connecting to a mainframe somewhere else, often with delays and limitations. Today, a few clicks provide 4GB, 8GB, or 32GB of GPU power instantly. Cloud platforms have made high-end computing accessible to every developer.

Improved algorithms. New AI models appear constantly. But the real reason for this speed is that everything is open source. This is no longer enterprise-controlled. Developers everywhere contribute to global progress.

Open contribution. The open

source ecosystem is what accelerates this industry. Every improvement becomes available to everyone. This is why the field feels like it is moving at lightning speed.

Closing

AI is everywhere. AI is everything. But unless we define our own box, we will be overwhelmed. No organisation progresses linearly, and no developer can afford to work without understanding the business and refinement cycle. AI demands a different way of thinking, structured, strategic and continuously evolving. **EFY**

This article is based on insights from the AI Dev-Con session 'Beyond Automation - Strategic AI integration with GenAI and LLM' by Pradeeba P, Delivery Manager at Thoughtworks. She comes with more than 16 years of experience delivering AI and digital solutions that drive measurable business value for global customers, and has completed the AI Strategies for Leaders program at Northwestern Kellogg School of Management. The discussion was transcribed and curated by Apurba Sen, Senior Journalist, EFY.

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